The מפרשים point out that ספר שמות is the ספר of גאולה. We start out with יציאת מצרים and conclude with the משכן. That's the entire ספר שמות in one sentence - a tremendous גאולה. There are many reasons we were זוכה to this גאולה, and I'd like to discuss one of them from an enigmatic portion of פרשת שמות.

הקב"ה reveals Himself to משה רבינו at the סנה (3:2): וְהַסְּנֶה אֵינֶנּוּ אֻכָּל. As an aside, the word אייניקל, which I've probably taught to many of my children and אייניקלעך, comes from the root of אֵינֶנּוּ אֻכָּל - many people don't know that. Returning to the topic, after the סנה, הקב"ה tells משה, "I want you to go to מצרים and get the Jews out." What does משה say? "Sure, Hashem, I'm glad to go"? No, he didn't say that. Rather, he said, "No, I'm not worthy to go. I shouldn't go. I can't speak well because of my speech impediment." This goes on and on, פסוק after פסוק, with משה repeatedly saying "No". משה felt he wasn't the right person to take בני ישראל out of מצרים. Finally, the פסוק states (4:14): וַיִּחַר אַף ה' בְּמֹשֶׁה - Hashem became angry with משה; וַיֹּאמֶר הֲלֹא אַהֲרֹן אָחִיךָ הַלֵּוִי יָדַעְתִּי כִּי דַבֵּר יְדַבֵּר הוּא - אַהֲרֹן will be your spokesman. However, the פסוק uses a very powerful לשון: וַיִּחַר אַף ה', which in English is generally translated as "Hashem's anger flared up against משה."

The גמרא in זבחים ק"ב ע"א explains that according to רבי יהושע בן קרחה every time the תורה uses the phrase ויחר אף it indicates some sort of עונש, because Hashem doesn't get angry, but anger כביכול flares up. However, רבי יהושע בן קרחה points out one exception: in our פסוק, משה רבינו doesn't receive any punishment.

But, as always, there's a מחלוקת. ר' שמעון בר יוחי disagrees and asserts that משה רבינו was indeed punished. How do we see this? The פסוק says הֲלֹא אַהֲרֹן אָחִיךָ **הַלֵּוִי** יָדַעְתִּי כִּי דַבֵּר יְדַבֵּר. We know אַהֲרֹן is not referred to as a לוי; why does the תורה call him הלוי? We know that אַהֲרֹן was destined to be the כהן גדול. With these words, the מדרש explains that Hashem was telling משה, "I had intended for you to be the כהן גדול and for אַהֲרֹן to remain a לוי. But now, because of your repeated refusals, you will remain a לוי, and he will be the כהן גדול." This raises a question: even רבי יהושע בן קרחה would have to admit that this outcome is a punishment. After all, we know that אַהֲרֹן became the כהן גדול and משה remained a לוי. So how could רבי יהושע בן קרחה claim that משה wasn't punished?

R' Chaim Shmuelevitz offers a powerful insight from the מדרש. When ניסוך השמן was performed during אַהֲרֹן's inauguration as כהן גדול, משה רבינו witnessed the oil flowing over אַהֲרֹן's head, down his face, and onto his beard. The מדרש describes how משה was so thrilled and joyous that it was as if the oil was being poured on his own head. משה's joy at his brother's elevation to כהן גדול was entirely genuine. From this medrash, רבי יהושע בן קרחה's position becomes clear. Even though משה lost the opportunity to become כהן גדול, it wasn't considered a punishment. His שמחה for his brother's accomplishment was so deep and sincere that it was as if he himself had been appointed כהן גדול. This is a tremendous מדרגה, especially when we consider the קנאה seen among יוסף's brothers and the praise bestowed upon מנשה and אפרים by their lack of קנאה. משה's ability to feel such genuine happiness for his brother is extraordinary.

How can we hope to achieve this level? First, by learning about it. Second, by practicing it. Third, by inculcating within ourselves the ability to genuinely rejoice in the success of others without jealousy. הקב"ה gives everyone exactly what is meant for them. Never feel bad about someone else's achievements. In fact, פונקט פאַרקערט, you should be thrilled for them. Strive to make your happiness for someone else equal to the joy you'd feel if you had achieved it yourself. In that זכות, we will have a גאולה, all our קינדערלעך and all of כלל ישראל will have a tremendous ישועה. We're in the midst of this difficult and horrible מלחמה (written during the war in Gaza). May הקב"ה grant each חַיָל and every Jew, wherever they are, tremendous הצלחה and נִצָּחוֹן. Here in חוץ לארץ, we are also facing ניסיונות, being ridiculed and threatened. Bezras Hashem, we should all hear good news.

https://youtu.be/XW7WzG_UmSs